

Lexicon of Priors



Prior Distribution

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Structure - Ordered Knowledge



Prior Distribution



What was believed before any data. This encodes expectation, tradition, expertise, bias; it is wisdom and dogma. Combined by Bayes with likelihood and evidence to the posterior distribution.



domain knowledge, conventional knowledge, bayes, (non)informative/improper priors, conjugacy



Supports learning with sanity and stability.



Tradition becomes law, deeper knowledge is ignored.



Disregard all insider knowledge about target card, then estimate its distribution.



"Which distribution did you inherit for convenience and how might it mask a more complex truth?"



Scholars copied the Lexicon for centuries, adding notes in the margins. Some ink was truth, some habit. But the discussions were not about that.

